

CASE ID: 202001710316

EPISODE NAME: Czech Senate Support for Taiwan

2020/01/10 - 2021/08/31

Sender: China (710)

Target: Czech Republic (316)

Issue: Retaliate for Alliance or Alignment Choice (7)

Final Outcome: Stalemate in the Threat Stage (4)

Narrative

On 2020/01/10, China threatened to retaliate against important Czech companies if Chairman of the Czech Senate Jaroslav Kubera visited Taiwan.¹ Specifically, in a formal letter sent to the Czech president's office, the China's embassy in Prague threatened to make firms such as Skoda, Home Credit Group, and Petrof Pianos "suffer".² Kubera had announced the trip on 2019/11/05.³

The trip never occurred because Kubera died unexpectedly on 2020/01/20.⁴ However, Kubera's successor, Miloš Vystrčil, visited Taiwan on 2020/08/29.⁵ In response, on 2020/08/31, China's foreign ministry issued a statement claiming that Vystrčil would "pay a heavy price" and that China would take "corresponding measures."⁶

No sanctions appear to have been imposed.

¹ Carey, Nick, and Satter, Raphael. "China threatened to harm Czech companies over Taiwan visit - letter." February 19th, 2020.
<https://www.reuters.com/article/us-china-czech-taiwan/china-threatened-to-harm-czech-companies-over-taiwan-visit-letter-idUSKBN20D0G3>.

² Ibid.

³ Stephens, Jack. "Senate President Kubera To Visit Taiwan Amid Tensions In Czech-Chinese Relations." Brno Daily, 5 Nov. 2019.
<https://brnodaily.com/2019/11/05/news/politics/senate-president-kubera-to-visit-taiwan-amid-tensions-in-czech-chinese-relations/>

⁴ Ibid.

⁵ "Senate President Miloš Vystrčil flies to Taiwan accompanied by a ninety-member delegation (29.08.2020)." The Czech Senate, 29 Aug. 2020.
https://www.senat.cz/zpravodajstvi/zprava.php?ke_dni=31.8.2020&O=12&id=3012&from=M

⁶ Davidson, Helen. "Taiwan: angry China vows 'corresponding measures' over Czech visit." *The Guardian*, 1 Sept. 2020.
<https://www.theguardian.com/world/2020/sep/01/taiwan-angry-china-vows-corresponding-measures-over-czech-visit>